CodeCompass

Setup, deployment and everyday Git checklist · Vite + React + Firebase + Vercel · prepared 28 Oct 2026

Highlighted = common routine you repeat for every project Tip Important

1. Daily identity check (who am I pushing as?)
2. Switching between Sujata and Supriya
3. Check your tools
4. Run the project on your laptop
5. Firebase setup (free)
6. Gmail for sign-in codes
7. Put the code on GitHub
8. Deploy on Vercel
9. Connect Firebase to your link
10. Test and install on your phone
11. Every later update
12. Quick reference and troubleshooting

1 · Daily identity check: who am I pushing as?

This laptop has two GitHub accounts (Sujata and Supriya). Run this check **every time you open a project**, before you commit or push.

COMMON · EVERY PROJECT · EVERY SESSION

A. Which VS Code profile and account am I in?

- **VS Code profile:** the gear icon (bottom-left) → **Profiles**. The active profile shows a tick. Use *Dev Code Zone* for your work and *Supriya* for hers.
- **VS Code's GitHub sign-in:** the person icon (bottom-left, **Accounts**) shows which GitHub account VS Code uses for sync and the Source Control panel.

B. Which name, email, repo and login will Git use here?

```
git config user.name                  # name on your commits
git config user.email                 # email on your commits (decides whose GitHub
profile they appear on)
git config --show-origin user.email   # where it comes from: this repo (.git/config) or
global
git remote -v                         # which GitHub repo you push to
git config credential.username        # which GitHub login is used for this repo (blank =
default)
```

C. Which GitHub logins are saved on this computer?

```
git credential-manager github list    # Windows / Git Credential Manager: lists saved
GitHub accounts
gh auth status                        # only if GitHub CLI is installed
```

The results must all match the person who owns this project. If anything is wrong, fix it with section 2 before committing.

COMMON · AFTER EVERY PUSH

D. Confirm the push went to the right place

```
git log -1 --format="%h  %an <%ae>  %s"   # author of your latest commit
git status -sb                             # "## main...origin/main" with nothing ahead
= fully pushed
```

Then open the repo on github.com → **Commits**. Your latest commit should show **your** avatar and username. A grey avatar means the commit email isn't linked to that GitHub account; fix `user.email`.

2 · Switching between Sujata and Supriya

Set identity **per project** with `--local`. Never use `--global` for this on a shared laptop, so one person's settings never leak into the other's projects.

COMMON · ONCE PER PROJECT

Sujata's project

```
git config --local user.name "Sujata
Kumari"
git config --local user.email "<sujata-
github-email>"
git config --local credential.username
<sujata-github-username>
git remote set-url origin
https://<sujata-github-
username>@github.com/<sujata-github-
username>/<repo>.git
```

Supriya's project

```
git config --local user.name "Supriya"
git config --local user.email "<supriya-
github-email>"
git config --local credential.username
<supriya-github-username>
git remote set-url origin
https://<supriya-github-
username>@github.com/<supriya-github-
username>/<repo>.git
```

Putting the username in the remote URL makes Git Credential Manager pick the right saved login for that repo automatically. The first push for each account opens a browser login once.

Add a second account's login (first time only)

```
git credential-manager github login     # sign in with the other GitHub account in the
browser
git credential-manager github list      # both usernames should now be listed
```

If a push still goes out as the wrong person: Windows → **Credential Manager → Windows Credentials** → remove the `git:https://github.com` entries, then push again and sign in as the correct account.

3 · Check your tools

COMMON · NEW LAPTOP OR NEW PROJECT

```
node -v        # must be v22.12 or higher for CodeCompass
npm -v
git --version
```

Missing? Install **Node.js LTS** (nodejs.org) and **Git** (git-scm.com), then close and reopen VS Code. Open the terminal with **Terminal → New Terminal**.

```
dir            # Windows: you should see package.json (Mac: ls)
```

4 · Run the project on your laptop

COMMON · EVERY PROJECT

```
npm install      # install packages (first time, or after package.json changes)
npm test         # run tests — CodeCompass should show "47 passed"
npm run build    # production build — should end with "built in …"
npm run dev      # run locally → open http://localhost:5173 ; stop with Ctrl + C
```

Without Firebase keys, CodeCompass runs in "this device only" mode. Try **Explore demo data** to look around.

5 · Firebase setup (free Spark plan)

1. console.firebase.google.com → **Create a project** → name `codecompass` → Google Analytics **off** → Create. **Don't add billing.**
2. **Build → Authentication → Get started.** Optional: Sign-in method → **Google → Enable → Save**.
3. **Build → Firestore Database → Create database** → Standard → **asia-south1 (Mumbai)** → **Production mode** → Create.
4. ⚙ **Project settings → Your apps → </> Web** → nickname `codecompass` → Register app. Copy `apiKey`, `authDomain`, `projectId` and `appId`.
5. ⚙ **Project settings → Service accounts → Generate new private key.** From the downloaded .json, copy `project_id`, `client_email` and `private_key`.

Keep the service-account .json **outside** the project folder and never commit it. Delete it once the values are in Vercel.

6 · Gmail for sign-in codes (free, about 500 emails a day)

6. myaccount.google.com → **Security → 2-Step Verification → On**.

7. myaccount.google.com → search **App passwords** → name `CodeCompass` → Create → copy the 16-character password.
8. Create your OTP secret in the VS Code terminal, then copy the output:

```
node -e "console.log(require('crypto').randomBytes(32).toString('hex'))"
```

7 · Put the code on GitHub

9. github.com (signed in as **the owner**) → **New repository** → name `codecompass` → **Private** → Create. Don't add a README.

COMMON · FIRST PUSH OF ANY PROJECT

```
git init
git config --local user.name "Sujata Kumari"
git config --local user.email "<your-github-email>"
git config --local credential.username <your-github-username>

git add -A
git commit -m "CodeCompass first release"
git branch -M main
git remote add origin https://<your-github-username>@github.com/<your-github-
username>/codecompass.git
git push -u origin main
```

Before `git push`, run the **identity check (section 1 B)**. After it, run **section 1 D**.

`.gitignore` already keeps `node_modules`, `dist` and `.env.local` out of GitHub. Check with `git status` that no secret file is listed before committing.

8 · Deploy on Vercel (free Hobby plan)

10. vercel.com → sign in **with the same GitHub account** → **Add New → Project** → Import `codecompass`. Leave the build settings as detected (Vite).
11. Open **Environment Variables** and add every row below:

Name	Value
`VITE_FIREBASE_API_KEY`	apiKey (step 4)
`VITE_FIREBASE_AUTH_DOMAIN`	authDomain
`VITE_FIREBASE_PROJECT_ID`	projectId
`VITE_FIREBASE_APP_ID`	appId
`VITE_AUTH_METHODS`	`email,google` (or `email` if you skipped Google)
`FIREBASE_PROJECT_ID`	project_id (step 5)
`FIREBASE_CLIENT_EMAIL`	client_email
`FIREBASE_PRIVATE_KEY`	private_key, everything from `-----BEGIN` to `END PRIVATE KEY-----\n`
`OTP_SECRET`	output of step 8
`SMTP_HOST`	`smtp.gmail.com`
`SMTP_PORT`	`587`
`SMTP_USER`	the Gmail address
`SMTP_PASS`	the app password, without spaces
`MAIL_FROM`	`CodeCompass <the Gmail address>`

Only names starting with `VITE_` reach the browser. All the others stay secret on Vercel's server.

12 Click **Deploy**. Copy your link, e.g. `https://codecompass-xyz.vercel.app`.

9 · Connect Firebase to your link

13 Firebase → **Authentication → Settings → Authorized domains → Add domain** → `codecompass-xyz.vercel.app` (without https://).

14 Upload the security rules from the VS Code terminal:

```
npx firebase login                          # browser opens — use the Google account
that owns the Firebase project
npx firebase use --add                      # choose codecompass, alias: default
npx firebase deploy --only firestore:rules  # wait for "Deploy complete!"
```

15 Optional cleanup: Firestore → **TTL policies → Create policy** → collection group `otpChallenges`, field `expireAt`. Repeat with `otpIps`.

Don't share the link until step 14 says **Deploy complete!**. The rules are what keep every user's data private.

COMMON · FIREBASE CLI CHECK

```
npx firebase login:list     # which Google account the Firebase CLI is using
npx firebase use            # which Firebase project this folder deploys to
```

On a shared laptop, if this shows the other person's account: `npx firebase logout`, then `npx firebase login`.

10 · Test and install on your phone

16. Open your link on the laptop → enter your email → **Email me a code** → type the code. Check Spam the first time and mark it "Not spam".
17. Add one question. Open the link on your phone and sign in with the same email; the question is there.
18. **Android (Chrome):** open the link → ⋮ → **Install app**. **iPhone (Safari):** open the link → **Share → Add to Home Screen**.
19. Sign in with a different email: you get an empty, separate account. Then share the link; everyone gets their own account.

11 · Every later update

COMMON · EVERY CHANGE, EVERY PROJECT

```
# 1. Identity check (section 1 B)
git config user.email
git remote -v

# 2. Get the latest and make sure it works
git pull
npm install
npm test
npm run build

# 3. Save and send
git status                        # review what changed; no secret files
git add -A
git commit -m "Describe the change"
git push

# 4. Confirm (section 1 D)
git log -1 --format="%h  %an <%ae>  %s"
git status -sb
```

Vercel redeploys automatically after each push. Installed apps show **"Reload to update"**.

COMMON · WORKING ON A BRANCH (optional, safer for big changes)

```
git switch -c feature/my-change      # new branch
git add -A
git commit -m "Work in progress"
git push -u origin feature/my-change # Vercel gives this branch its own preview link
# when happy: open a Pull Request on GitHub → Merge → then locally:
git switch main
git pull
```

12 · Quick reference and troubleshooting

What you see	Fix
The app says accounts aren't set up	A `VITE_FIREBASE_*` value is missing or misspelled in Vercel. Fix it → **Deployments → ⋯ → Redeploy**.
"Sign-in is temporarily unavailable"	A server variable is wrong, usually `FIREBASE_PRIVATE_KEY` or `OTP_SECRET`. Check Vercel → **Logs**.
"We couldn't send the email"	Wrong `SMTP_USER` / `SMTP_PASS`, or 2-Step Verification is off. Make a new app password.
Code email doesn't arrive	Check Spam. Gmail allows about 500 a day; for more users switch to Brevo (SETUP-ACCOUNTS.md).
"This website address isn't allowed to sign in"	Add your exact Vercel domain in Firebase Authorized domains (step 13).
"Sync problem" in the app	Deploy the rules (step 14) and check the Firestore database exists.
Commit shows the wrong person on GitHub	Fix `user.email` with `git config --local` (section 2). Old commits keep their author.
`git push` → "Permission denied" or 403	You're logged in as the other account. Put the right username in the remote URL (section 2), or clear Windows Credential Manager and push again.
`npm` or `node` not found	Install Node.js LTS, then close and reopen VS Code.
Tests or build fail after `git pull`	Run `npm install` again, then `npm test`.

Free-plan limits: Vercel Hobby is for non-commercial use. Firebase Spark and Gmail SMTP are free; if a daily limit is reached, that service pauses until the next day and never charges. Fuller details are in `DEPLOY-STEPS.md`, `SETUP-ACCOUNTS.md` and `SECURITY.md` inside the project.